For some reason or another, I haven't managed to score many runs there, and my fortunes didn't change as this decisive Test unfolded as a closely contested arm wrestle. We made 309, after recovering from 105 for five. They made 315 in their first innings after getting into trouble at 54 for four. Another century by Hashim, with some support from me and the lower order, enabled us to reach 351, eventually setting England a target of 346 to win the Test and level the series.

Vernon Philander was producing yet another remarkable performance. He had contributed invaluable scores of 61 and 35 with the bat, and took five for 30 in the England second innings. We survived a scare when Matt Prior looked as if he could inspire a successful chase, but we held our nerve and won by 51 runs.

The 2–0 series victory meant we displaced England as the No. 1 team in the Test rankings. As far as many of us were concerned, the seeds of our triumph had been sown far away in the Swiss Alps.

The ODI series was drawn 2–2, and our victory in a T20 international in Durham offered encouragement that we could move on and mount a strong bid to prevail in the next challenge.

Next stop … the ICC World Twenty20 in Sri Lanka.

I was certainly busy, captaining the team, batting at No. 4 and keeping wicket, and we appeared to be gathering momentum when we defeated Zimbabwe and won a rain-reduced seven-over shootout against the hosts, but our form ebbed away. We were on course to beat Pakistan, but found a way to lose the match, and we were then well beaten by Australia, blown away by an extraordinary Shane Watson innings. We lost our last match against India by a single run, a close finish to end a dismal day when both teams were eliminated from the tournament.

'AB, we should go to the press conference,' said Lerato Malekutu, our outstanding media officer.

My heart sank at the prospect. I enjoyed almost every aspect of